



RED BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	22 nd November 2022	Time of Incident:	13:38
Directorate / Region:	Wheatbelt Region	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury/ Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	29127
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Metal fragment penetrates worker's eye during grinding activity
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What Happened:	
A Worker was tasked with carrying out grinding activities at a bridge refurbishment site and completed their shift with no incident being reported. At the completion of shift, the Worker returned home and began to feel pain in their left eye. The Worker attended site the next day and reported the discomfort to their supervisor. After reporting the incident, the Worker was taken to a medical facility, where a metal shard was removed from their left eye. The incident is reportable to WorkSafe, being an “injury that involves an object penetrating the eye (for example metal fragment, wood chip)”. A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.	
Immediate Actions:	
<i>Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):</i> - Review SWMS to ensure that correct PPE is captured in the controls - Ensure Workers who are conducting grinding activities are wearing the correct PPE - Communicate incident reporting requirements to all personnel	
Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations